

VS APPROVALMAX

ABOUT LIGHTYEAR

Lightyear is an AP automation platform built for businesses that want complete control over supplier invoices — from automated price checking and PO matching to multi-tier approvals and statement reconciliation. Part of The Access Group.

Start a free trial →

ABOUT APPROVALMAX

Approval workflow automation connecting to Xero, QuickBooks, and NetSuite. December 2025 price update confirmed. Strong multi-entity approval routing. No native invoice capture — requires a capture tool alongside it.

LIGHTYEAR WINS WHEN...

- Prospect needs invoice capture, not just approvals
- Price verification against supplier contracts
- Statement reconciliation is a pain point
- Fraud risk on bank detail changes
- Full AP workflow in one platform

RATINGS

G2 Rating 4.7 / 5 214 reviews	Capterra 4.8 / 5 130 reviews
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PRICING MODEL

Entry price (GBP)	£39/mo
Entry price (AUD)	A\$72/mo
Billing	Per entity/month
Annual discount	Yes
Starter includes	1 entity
Overage policy	Per extra entity

FREE TRIAL

Free trial	30 days
Credit card req.	No
Demo available	Yes

LIGHTYEAR VS APPROVALMAX — FEATURE COMPARISON

FEATURE	LIGHTYEAR	APPROVALMA
Invoice capture	AI + OCR	Via Xero only
Approval routing	Up to 8	Multi-tier
PO creation	Yes	Yes
3-way matching	Line-level	Basic
Price checking	Automated	No
Statement recon	Automated	No
Fraud detection	Bank details	No
Multi-entity	Unlimited	Unlimited
Storage	7 years	Xero hosted
Free trial	30 days	30 days

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WHY LIGHTYEAR — KEY DIFFERENCES

Beyond Approvals

ApprovalMax makes sure the right people say yes. Lightyear makes sure what they're saying yes to is correct — checking prices against agreed rates.

Invoice Capture Included

Lightyear includes AI-powered invoice capture natively. ApprovalMax relies on Xero or a third-party capture tool — an extra cost and integration.

Statement Reconciliation

Lightyear automates supplier statement reconciliation with one-click copy requests. ApprovalMax has no statement reconciliation.

Fraud Prevention

Lightyear flags when supplier bank details on an invoice differ from your records. ApprovalMax has no equivalent protection.

Price Checking

Automated comparison of invoice line items against your agreed supplier pricelists — catching overcharges before approval. ApprovalMax has no price checking.